The Moon · Tier Pack · Independent

Learning goal: I can explain how the Moon orbits the Earth and why we see different Moon phases.

Independent Route (Book First)

Draw the Sun, Earth, and Moon at New Moon and Full Moon, shade the unlit half of the Moon, and explain why the Moon appears to change shape over 28 days.

Help: The Sun always lights __ of the Moon. As the Moon orbits Earth in __ days, we see different amounts of the __ half.

Optional Make It · Independent

Make a Dual-View Moon Orbit Wheel

Draw the 4 main orbit positions (New, First Quarter, Full, Third Quarter) showing both Which half is lit from space and What we see from Earth, plus your book explanation.

Word Help

natural satellite: a body in space, like the Moon, that orbits a planet

reflect: when light from the Sun bounces off the surface of the Moon

phases of the Moon: the changing shapes of the sunlit part of the Moon as seen from Earth

waxing and waning: waxing means the lit part we see is growing; waning means it is shrinking

Exit Check

How many days does the Moon take to orbit the Earth once?

Where does the light we see from the Moon come from?